



Minnehaha Community: Response to Covid-19

As of March 11, 2020

The staff and leadership at Minnehaha is watching the progression of the novel coronavirus (Covid-19) in our community, and wanted to share our thoughts and plans for helping prevent the spread and care for those in our congregation and beyond.

First off, we recognize that this situation is constantly changing. If changes are made/cancellations happen, we will use our website, the e-news, Facebook, and an outgoing message on the church voicemail to let you know.

We are looking to the CDC, the Minnesota Department of Health, and our public schools to help make decisions that are best practice.

When attending Minnehaha events (worship, meetings, fellowship events and more):

- Greet one another in ways that don't involve hugging or shaking hands. Cross your arms across your chest, offer an elbow bump, or place your hands in prayer position at your breastbone and give a little head bow to the other person.
- Practice good hygiene. Stay home if you are feeling ill. Wash your hands regularly, and avoid touching your face unless you know your hands are clean.
- We know this is allergy season, and we know that just moving from the cold outside to a warm building can cause noses to run and people to cough and sneeze. Cough and sneeze into your elbow. Better yet, carry tissues so that you can cough, sneeze, blow your nose and then discard the tissue right away. We know this is not our best environmental practice, but encourage it for this period of time.
- We will continue to use best practices around communion: with individual cups, only the servers touching the bread and disinfecting their hands immediately before serving.
- If you don't want to touch hymnals, the words to our hymns are already projected onto the screen.

We want to reassure you that:

- None of the gatherings at Minnehaha exceed the 250 person limit that some locations are putting into place. With this in mind, at this point we are not cancelling any events.
- We are working on ways we can meet remotely should we need to cancel anything. We have access to Google Hangouts, and leaders of groups and committees are encouraged to contact Peter Ketcham about using that technology if you need help.
- We currently record our sermons, so if you have to stay home, you can listen to the sermon online.
- We are also working on being able to livestream our entire worship services for those who cannot go out in public. We need about \$3,500 more to buy the necessary cameras, and once we have raised that money, we will take the final steps to begin live streaming. *If you would like to contribute to this fund, see information below.*
- Staff and leaders are encouraged to stay home if they are ill, and we will adapt as necessary.
- We are creating a "clean team" to work with our custodian on wiping down commonly and heavily used areas, and special procedures will be put in place if we hear of anyone infected with Covid-19 has been in our building.
- We are in communication with our renters, who all have their own policies about gathering, all of which are very similar to ours.

If you have any concerns or are in need of support, please contact the church office at 612.721.6231. Join us in praying for those who are ill, for our health care workers, for community leaders, for all those whose lives are being impacted.

To contribute to the live streaming camera fund, send a check to the church office with "Live Streaming" in the memo line, or use your Give Plus app.